needed to blurt out some of my innermost feelings to someone who was deeply involved in my cricket.

I was genuinely upset. To get rid of him as head coach while he was in the process of embedding a new generation of England players was, in my view, an avoidable error of judgement. He was, for instance, helping Ben Stokes through that formative initial cycle of being good, bad and average. Straussy acknowledged my input as captain, but was adamant we needed a more hands-off coach, in the mould of Duncan Fletcher.

Moores deserved better than to be subjected to another PR disaster, when his departure was reported prematurely during a washed-out one-day international in Dublin, and not confirmed, along with the appointment of Strauss, until the following day. My sympathy for Peter was genuine, though I welcomed Andrew's replacement of Paul Downton.

Andrew was not coming in on mate's rates. He balanced our friendship with his authority, and I respected him as a leader who made, and stood by, difficult decisions. That's how a hierarchical system should work. He was brilliant for me, and I had no problem with him being firm in his demands of me.

KP was successfully reintegrating himself into county cricket with Surrey, but on the night before he completed an unbeaten innings of 355 against Leicestershire, Strauss told him his England career was over because of a 'massive trust issue'. Kevin spoke of 'deceit' following his invitation to the meeting by Tom Harrison, the new chief executive of the ECB.

To be brutally honest, when Strauss told me of his intentions, I went out and got drunk. Before that admission is taken out of context, I want to stress that this was not due to any personal animosity towards Kevin. We had both been dehumanized by the controversy, reduced to tokens of an argument staged, largely, by people who had never met us. I was relieved, released by the finality of the decision. It is no coincidence that, from that moment on, I found greater comfort in my batting.

It was a time to re-evaluate, and repair personal relationships. I thought back to Antigua and the gym at Sugar Ridge, where Michael Vaughan and I had studiously ignored one another over a couple of days as we had completed our respective workouts. He had been critical of me. He had also piled into Trotty without knowing the circumstances when he left the Ashes tour in 2014.